Tryout stations and movement warmup

For Coach Garay and Christian Unified varsity soccer. Use these station cards to teach and evaluate a Spanish-inspired 4-2-3-1 identity through three 90-minute sessions.

Operating plan: 20 outfield candidates and two goalkeepers. Four supervised stations, four leaders, four groups of five outfield players. Goalkeeper assignments are specified separately. Page 24 gives a two-coach alternative.

What to prepare before players arrive

1. Label pinnies and establish a private number-to-name list. Ask for primary and secondary position preferences.

2. Set up stations, check the surface and anchored goals, identify the school emergency procedure and have water available. Honor restrictions communicated by authorized staff.

3. Show one example before starting each task. Give comparable opportunities, record context and use N/O when an action was not observed.

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Program standard

Christian character, classroom responsibility and purposeful competition guide the environment. Evaluate football ability with repeated evidence. Communication, accountability and service help identify captain candidates. An injury restriction is not a character score.

Field layout and equipment

Keep ball flight, waiting areas and walking traffic separate. The diagram is a planning example; choose actual spacing for your field and keep goal-directed activity inside its supervised area.

Four working areas with at least 5 yards between boundaries



Green = attacking team Red = defenders Gold = neutral or server Gray = rest or observer
Solid arrow = ball Dashed arrow = player movement Triangle = cone or exit gate. Positions are schematic.

Arrange each station

A and B: put spare balls on the outside edge. **C:** place the mini-goal so shots stay away from the corridor. **D:** use an anchored full goal, put waiting players behind the service line, and give its keeper coach an unobstructed view. Keep station D beyond the other stations rather than firing toward them.

Item	Practical quantity	Use
Balls	18 to 24	One per pair in warmup; 3 to 5 spares at each station
Flat markers and cones	40 to 50	Boundaries, two-yard gates and warmup lanes
Pinnies	Two team colors plus numbered bibs	Match number to evaluation record
Goals	Two full goals for later games; mini-goals or cone gates	Use controlled gates if a safe goal is unavailable
Coach materials	Four clipboards or tablets, timer and whistle	Station cards, ratings and minutes log

Warm up in a separate 25 x 24 area. If one field is available, use removable flat markers so station cones do not obstruct later games.

Day 1 technical baseline

Purpose: observe receiving, individual decisions, finishing and response to one coaching cue before evaluating larger team relationships.

Minute	Activity	What the coach records
0 to 15	Progressive movement warmup	Follow pages 4 to 9. Look for preparation and control.
15 to 35	Four technical stations	Four rotations: 4 minutes work plus 1 minute movement.
35 to 55	Two simultaneous 4v4 games	20 outfield players: 16 play, four rotate. Keepers work with station D leader.
55 to 80	7v7 plus two keepers	16 active; six outfield players rotate. Three 7-minute bouts and two 2-minute breaks.
80 to 86	One cue and targeted retest	Repeat a previously observed action with the same pressure.
86 to 90	Easy recovery and next-day brief	Private questions, equipment and attendance plan.

Time	Group 1	Group 2	Group 3	Group 4
15 to 20	A	B	C	D
20 to 25	B	C	D	A
25 to 30	C	D	A	B
30 to 35	D	A	B	C

Keepers: both stay at D during the station block; one plays while the other observes, then swap approximately every two minutes. During 4v4, use manageable service and distribution with their coach. Everyone joins the later game.

Game instructions

For 4v4, use two 28 x 22 areas with end gates. Four groups of five become two matches: each side has four players and one substitute; rotate the substitute every two minutes. For 7v7 plus keepers, use about 60 x 45. Preassign substitutions every 3 to 4 minutes and record minutes. Reward goals; observe scanning, support, recovery and decisions rather than adding many rules.

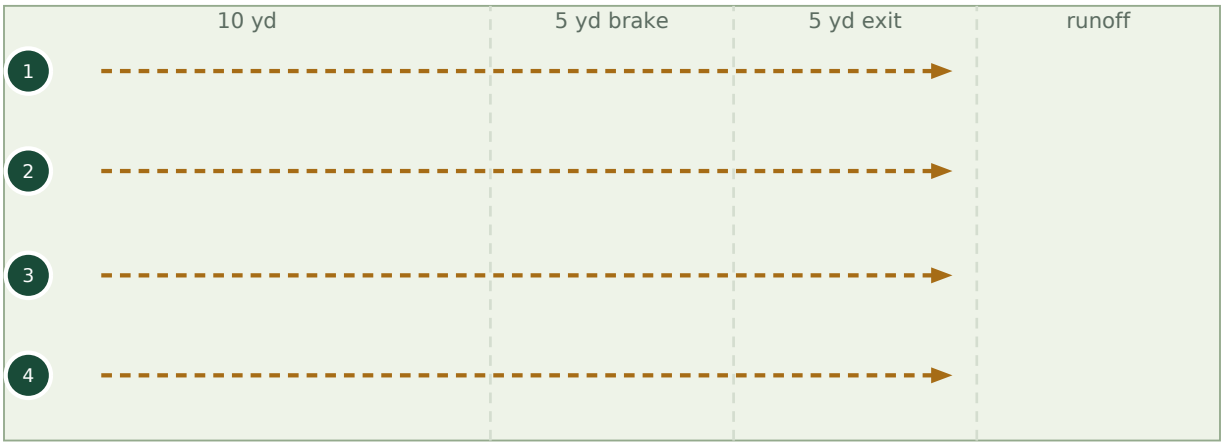
Retest: select uncertain observations rather than testing only the strongest players. Others do easy, supervised passing. Give one cue, watch the next opportunities, then revisit later without a reminder.

Progressive warmup running order

Prepare players for today’s football with a gradual increase in movement demand. This is a custom 15-minute sequence, not the complete FIFA 11+ programme. General design references appear on page 25.

Minute	Stage	Dose and purpose
0 to 3	Raise	Easy forward movement, lateral steps and controlled backward movement
3 to 6	Mobilize	Ankles, hips, hamstrings and controlled lateral range
6 to 10	Control	Squat, split stance, balance and low landing practice
10 to 13	Accelerate and brake	Four submaximal waves with a separate walking return
13 to 15	Connect to the ball	Receive, scan, move and pass; goalkeeper handling with staff

25 x 24 area Four lanes about 4 yards wide Walk back outside



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Teach before increasing speed

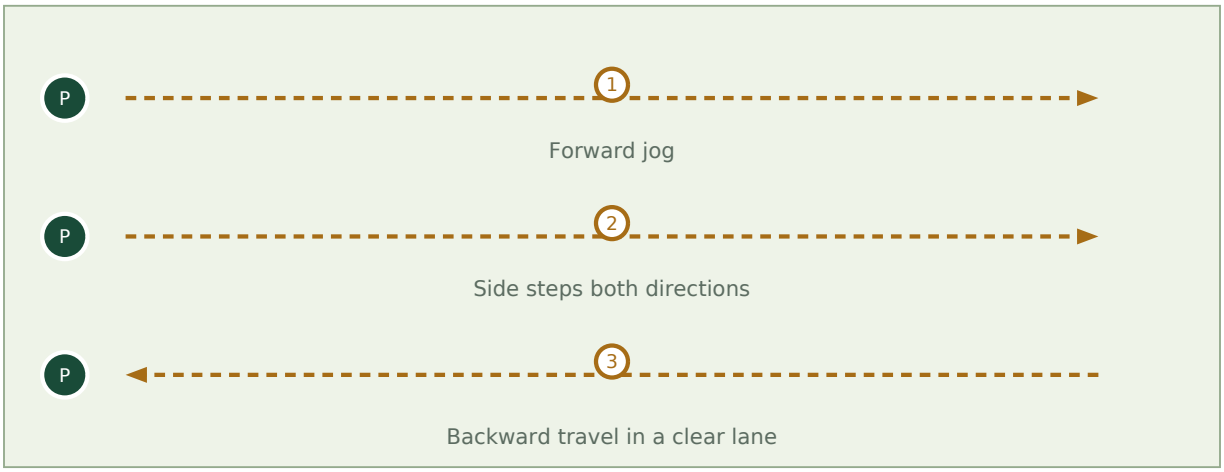
Demonstrate slowly, give one cue and watch a repetition. Use a comfortable range and controlled landing. If control deteriorates, reduce speed or use a simpler movement. Stop a painful activity and refer to the school’s qualified staff; do not use this sequence to clear an injury.

Across the days: Day 1 teach the route and planned direction. Day 2 repeat it, then add a simple visual cue if control is good. Day 3 keep the familiar sequence and reduce needless repetitions so players begin games ready. Extend preparation when needed and shorten the first main block rather than rushing.

Raise temperature and rehearse travel

Organization: four lanes, five or six players per lane, at least an arm span between players. Travel forward in the lane and walk back outside. Keep this stage conversational and unhurried.

Use the first 15 yards of the lane Return outside the working lane



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Time	Movement	How to perform
0:00 to 1:00	Easy jog forward	Short, relaxed steps; arms move naturally. Turn only at the marker and return outside.
1:00 to 2:00	Lateral shuffle	Slightly bend hips and knees. Step sideways without crossing feet; face the same direction on the next trip to load both sides.
2:00 to 3:00	Backward travel then forward jog	Look first to establish a clear route. Take short backward steps at low speed, then turn in open space and jog forward.

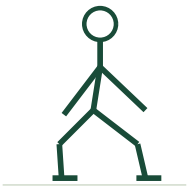
Coach from the side Watch spacing and whether players can change travel direction without collisions. Say “quiet feet and eyes up.”

Simplify Walk or shorten the travel distance. Do not race players during this phase.

Progress Add one relaxed skip on the last forward trip only if players are comfortable. Extra speed belongs in stage 4.

Mobilize ankles hips and hamstrings

Players spread into personal spaces. Model the movement at a comfortable range. The drawings show body positions rather than a required depth or joint angle. [1, 2]



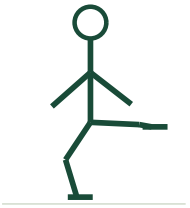
Ankle rock



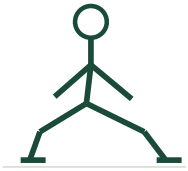
Lunge and reach



Hamstring sweep



Hip opening



Lateral rock

Time	Movement and dose	How to perform
3:00 to 3:30	Ankle rocks 6 each side	Stagger the feet. Keep the front heel down; guide the knee forward in line with the foot and return.
3:30 to 4:15	Alternating lunge 4 each side	Step into a modest split stance, bend both knees and reach the opposite arm upward. Push back to stand and alternate.
4:15 to 5:00	Hamstring sweeps 4 each side	Place one heel ahead, soften the standing knee and hinge at the hips. Sweep hands beside the shin; rise and change legs.
5:00 to 5:30	Hip opening 3 each side	Stand tall with support if needed. Lift one bent knee, open it sideways through comfortable range, return and lower.
5:30 to 6:00	Lateral rocks 3 each side	Widen the stance; shift hips toward one bent leg while the other lengthens. Keep feet grounded, return through center and change sides.

Correct one thing If the torso folds or balance is lost, shorten the range and slow down. Avoid forcing a stretch or bouncing at end range.

Transfer Ankle movement supports controlled stops; hip motion helps turning and changing direction. Keep the movements easy enough that the next stage remains crisp.

Activate balance and landing control

Keep the group spread out. Bodyweight only. Use low repetitions with time to demonstrate, reset and observe quality. Players work within an established comfortable range. [3, 4]



Sit hips back Bend both knees Hold one leg Land and hold

Time	Task	How to perform
6:00 to 6:45	Four controlled squats	Feet at a comfortable width. Sit hips back and bend knees over the direction of the feet; stand smoothly.
6:45 to 7:45	Four split-stance bends each side	Set a stable staggered stance. Lower slightly by bending both knees, then rise. Change the lead leg halfway.
7:45 to 8:30	Balance about 15 seconds each leg	Use a soft standing knee and level trunk. Briefly reach the free foot forward, return, then switch. Use light support if needed.
8:30 to 9:30	Three low jumps and controlled steps	Small two-foot jump, land quietly and hold for two seconds. Reset each time. Then make two controlled lateral step-and-holds each side.
9:30 to 10:00	Teach the braking route	Walk the acceleration and stop zones. Show where the return lane begins.

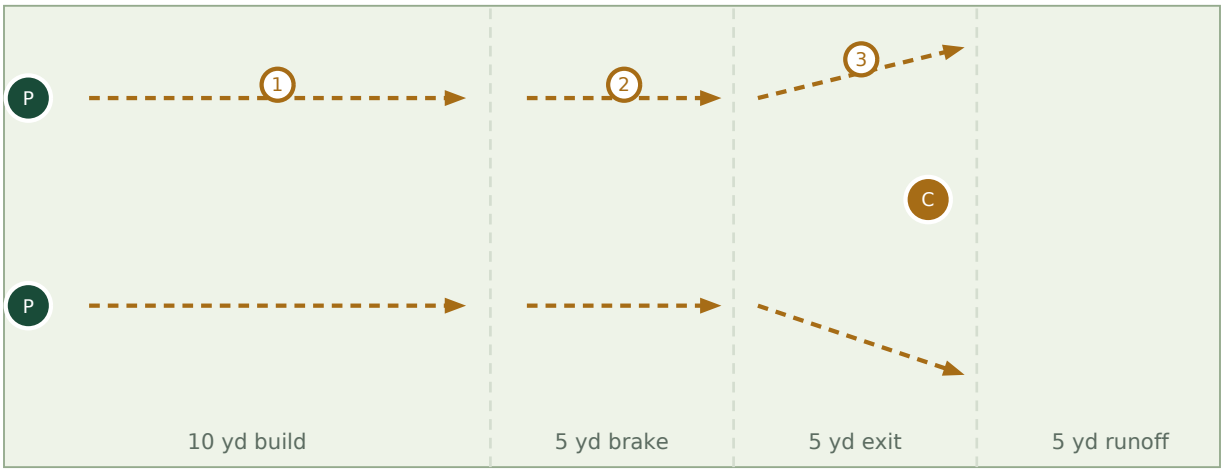
Coach from front and side Look for balance on landing and knees following the direction of the feet. Say “land softly, settle, then stand.”

Simplify or progress Replace jumps with a rise onto the toes and controlled lowering. Progress only after repeated stable repetitions; height and fatigue are not goals.

Build speed then control the stop

Use four lanes. Each 45-second wave gives each player one trip. Release the next player only when the braking area is clear. Walk back outside; adapt the clock if spacing needs more time.

25 yards total length Planned shallow exit Outside walking return



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Wave	Intent	Action
10:00 to 10:45	Easy build about 50 to 60 percent	Build for 10 yards; slow gradually across the next 5.
10:45 to 11:30	Comfortable build about 60 to 70 percent	Repeat; shorten steps as you brake, with eyes forward.
11:30 to 12:15	Brisk build about 70 to 80 percent	Brake under control, then make a planned shallow exit.
12:15 to 13:00	Up to about 80 to 85 percent if ready	Repeat a balanced stop and planned exit. Add a simple left/right cue only for players showing good control.

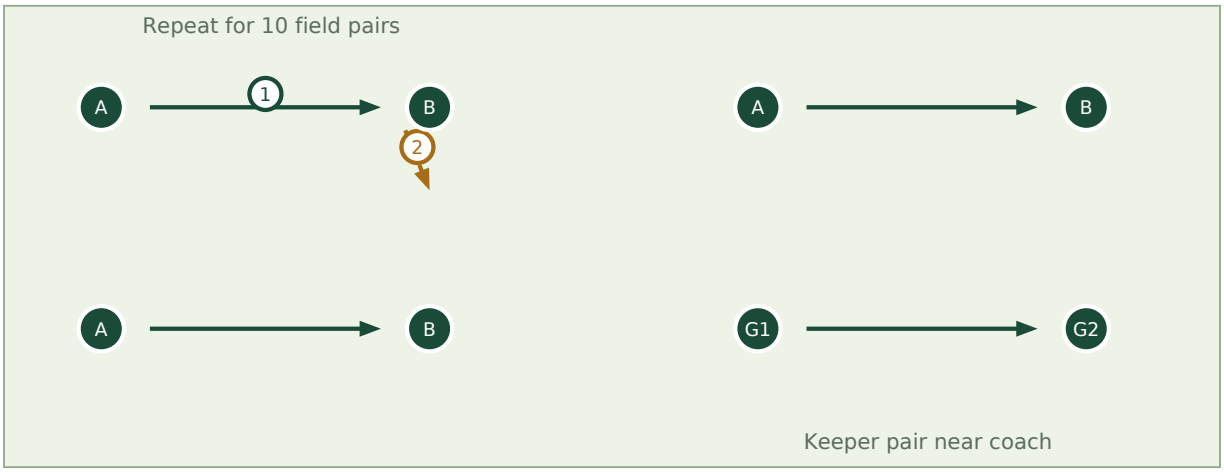
Cue “Build smoothly, take shorter braking steps, settle before changing direction.” These effort percentages are player estimates, not test scores.

Readiness This is preparation, not a timed sprint test. If players rush the stop or collide with a queue, reduce speed, lengthen the stop zone and delay the next start.

Add scanning receiving and the ball

Ten outfield pairs work in parallel corridors. The two keepers work as a nearby pair under the goalkeeper leader. Prepare eleven balls. Each pair uses about 8 yards of passing distance and stays in its own space.

Pairs shown schematically Keep separate ball lanes and personal movement space



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1. 13:00 to 14:00: A passes; B checks a shoulder as the passer prepares, opens the body and receives across it. B returns the ball and moves one or two steps to offer a fresh angle. Alternate receiving feet.

2. 14:00 to 15:00: the server shows an easy visual cue behind the receiver's shoulder before passing. The receiver checks, names the cue and chooses a useful first touch. Keep the pass manageable; do not force one-touch play.

3. Keeper pair: start with short foot passes, then staff-directed underarm service into secure handling. Reset, scan and roll or pass to the partner. Use controlled service; reserve advanced handling and diving for qualified keeper coaching.

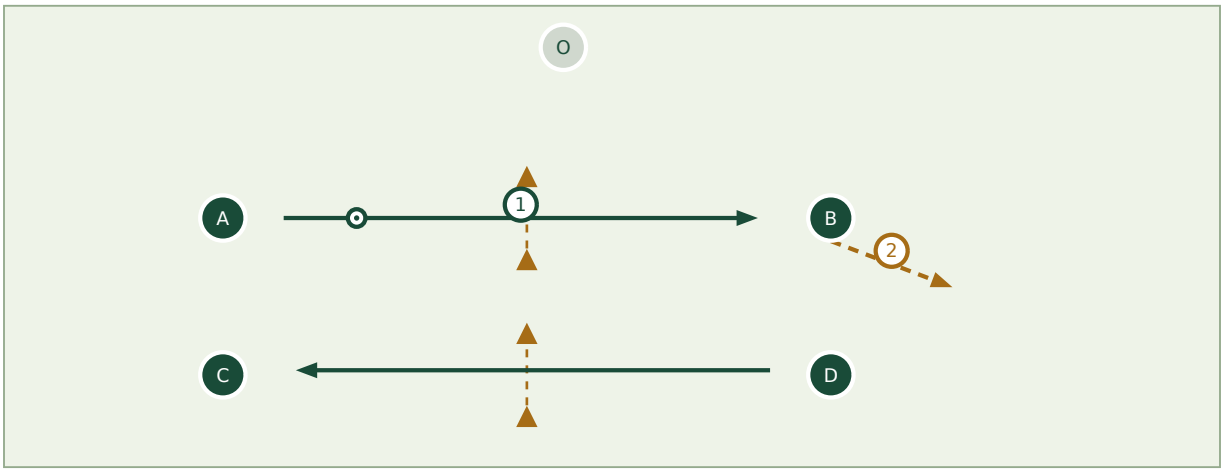
Observe Look for a real glance before the ball, a balanced receiving shape and a pass the teammate can use. Avoid treating a missed color call as a tryout score.

Connect to our identity Scan before receiving, create the next angle and help the next player. Move directly into the opening station while players remain warm.

Pass receive and open the body

16 x 12 area Two-yard gate Eight-yard pass | Four minutes of activity and one minute to record, drink and rotate.

16 x 12 area Two-yard gate Eight-yard pass



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Set up Two pairs pass in separate lanes. In each lane mark a two-yard passing gate about halfway. The fifth player observes one pair for 30 to 40 seconds, then joins while another observes.

Run the station

1. A passes through the gate to B. B checks over a shoulder, receives across the body with the first touch, then returns the ball. Keep the next pass within the player's lane.

2. After about one minute, change the starting angle or receiving foot. The server can move along the end line so the receiver must adjust the body.

3. Give each player the cue "check as the passer prepares." Sample the next five receptions, then stop prompting.

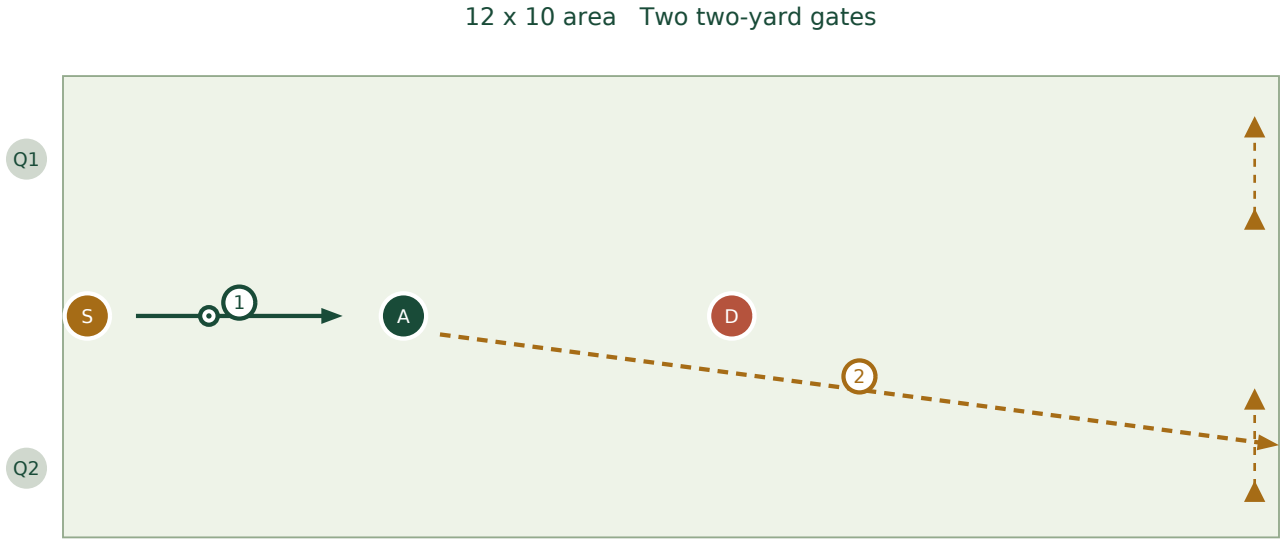
Coach and correct If the first touch stops under the body, slow the pass and ask the receiver to show the next action with the receiving foot. Cue "touch into your next pass."

Evaluate First-touch direction, pass weight, useful weaker-foot actions and improvement after the cue. Record controlled first touches out of a small equal sample; do not grade the observer's count alone.

Adjust Simplify to six-yard passes. Add a passive closing step by the server only after control is stable; keep both pairs physically separated.

One against one with two exits

12 x 10 area Two two-yard gates | Four minutes of activity and one minute to record, drink and rotate.



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Set up Five outfield players: attacker, defender, server and two resting players. Mark a gate at either far corner. Waiting players stay outside the near line.

Run the station

1. Server feeds the attacker; defender becomes live as the pass travels. Attacker scores by carrying with control through either far gate.

2. A defender who wins can carry over the near line. End after a score, ball out or about ten seconds; reset both players before the next ball.

3. Use the role cycle server to attacker to defender to rest one to rest two to server. Everyone receives comparable attacking and defending turns.

Coach and correct Attacker: “change pace after you move the defender.” Defender: “arrive under control and delay.” Stop a repetition if the queue enters the area.

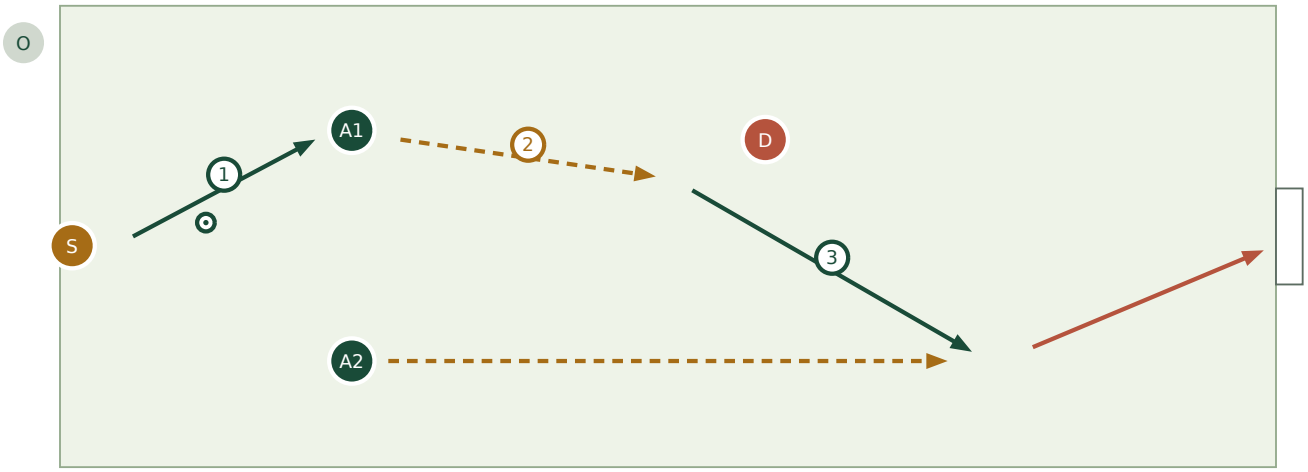
Evaluate Ball protection, ability to read inside/outside space, defender approach, balance and recovery effort. Record the opponent and pressure with the observation.

Adjust Give the attacker a larger starting gap for learning. Narrow the gap for a stronger pair; use the same comparison condition for candidates being evaluated together.

Two against one toward a goal

16 x 12 channel Mini-goal or two-yard gate | Four minutes of activity and one minute to record, drink and rotate.

16 x 12 channel Mini-goal or two-yard gate



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Set up Two attackers, one defender, one server and one observer. Put a mini-goal on the far line facing away from traffic; use a gate if no safe goal is available.

Run the station

1. Server feeds either attacker; the pair attacks the one defender. Ball carrier may carry to commit the defender, pass to the teammate or finish when the route is open.

2. Keep play live until a shot, controlled defender exit, ball out or about 12 seconds. Defender can counter across the near line.

3. Rotate server to first attacker to second attacker to defender to observer. Restart from either side so everyone experiences both supporting roles.

Coach and correct If attackers move on one straight line, show a useful diagonal support angle. Cue “make the defender choose.” Allow a carry or shot when it is the useful option.

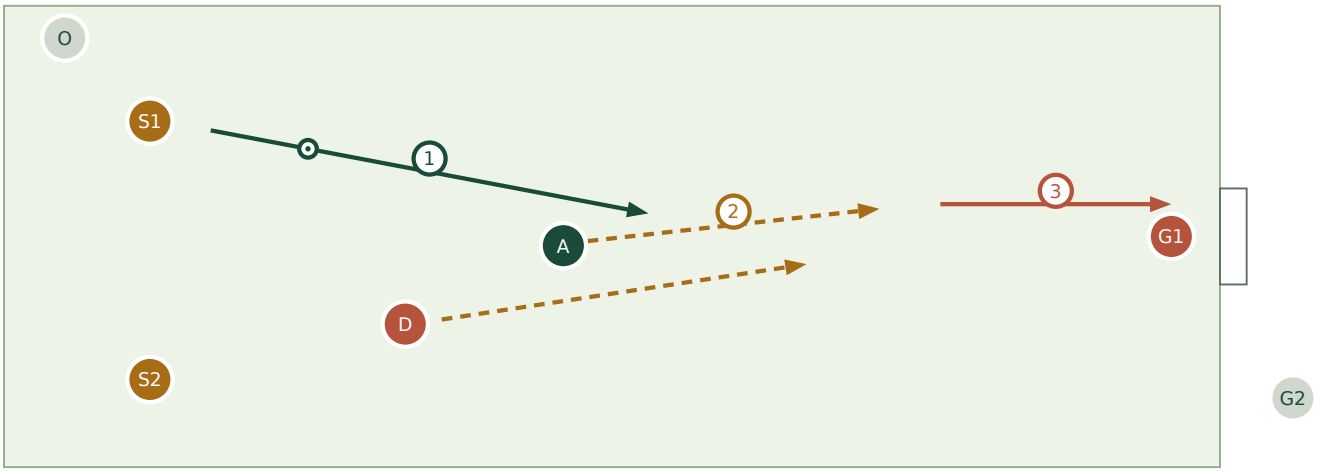
Evaluate Pass timing, support angle, weight of the final action, defender delay and next response after loss. A shot total by itself does not describe the decision.

Adjust Begin with a delaying defender and a wider channel. Progress to a fully live defender. Compare candidates in both ball-carrier and supporting roles.

Receive finish and recover

24 x 18 area One anchored goal Supervised service | Four minutes of activity and one minute to record, drink and rotate.

24 x 18 area One anchored goal Supervised service



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Set up Five outfield players rotate as two servers, attacker, recovering defender and observer. Two keepers remain at this station. One keeper plays; the other observes outside the shot path. The defender begins a few yards behind the attacker.

Run the station

1. Serve a manageable ground pass. The attacker takes a useful first touch and finishes while the defender recovers under control.

2. End after a shot, keeper control, ball out or controlled clearance. A new ball waits until the keeper and coach confirm readiness. No sliding challenges into the keeper.

3. Rotate S1 to attacker to defender to S2 to observer; change service side. Swap the keeper about every two minutes and balance service quality.

Coach and correct “Look at the keeper, set the ball and choose the finish.” If a first touch is too large, shorten the service and replay. Goalkeeper sets before the strike, then scans after securing.

Evaluate Finishing choice and execution, pressure response, recovery line, keeper readiness and retained distribution. Record the number and type of services each keeper faced.

Adjust Reduce defender speed or give a larger starting gap. Progress with an earlier recovering defender. Use gate finishing and keeper footwork/distribution if safe goal service is unavailable.

Day 2 pressure and position fit

Purpose: observe role relationships, build-out decisions, collective pressing and whether yesterday’s coaching transfers without repeated reminders.

Minute	Activity	What the coach records
0 to 15	Familiar progressive warmup	Repeat control standards before adding a simple visual cue.
15 to 35	Position stations A to D	Pages 15 to 18; same four-group rotation as Day 1.
35 to 55	Build-out and pressing game	Four blocks of four minutes, with one minute to rotate each time.
55 to 80	8v8 plus two keepers	18 active, four outfield substitutes. Three 7-minute bouts; two 2-minute breaks.
80 to 86	Feedback and retest	One cue, comparable repetitions and a later unprompted check.
86 to 90	Easy recovery and questions	Record primary/secondary roles to sample on Day 3.

Keeper assignments in the position block

GK1 starts at station A for build-out; GK2 starts at D for finishing and defensive organization. At minute 25 the keepers exchange A and D. The four outfield groups continue their five-minute clockwise rotation. Station B and C each use five outfield players; A and D use five outfield players plus a keeper.

What to observe in the larger game

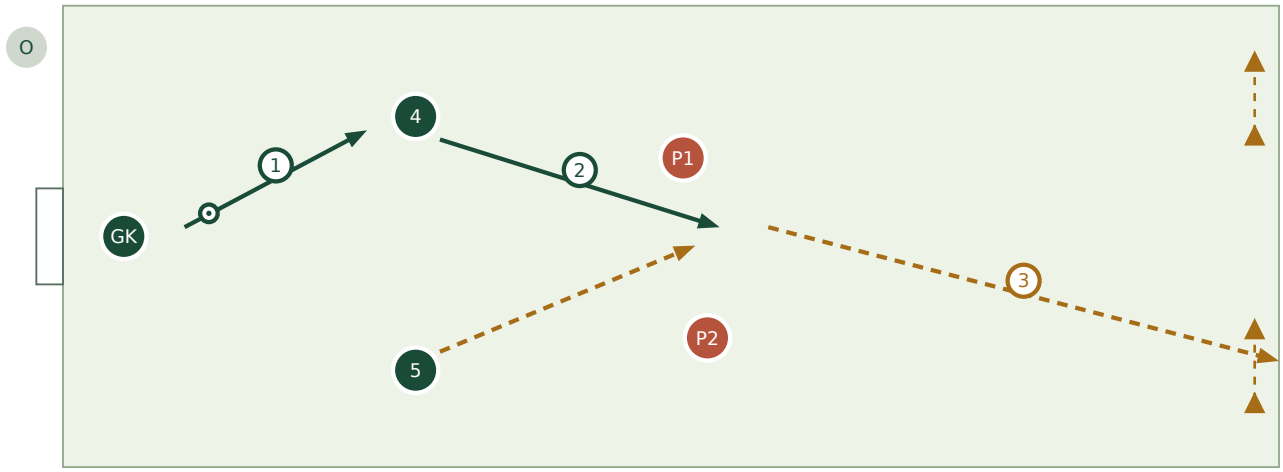
Use about 65 x 50 for 8v8 plus keepers, adjusted for the players. Teach a keeper, back three, two central midfielders, two wide players and a striker per side. This reduced game samples some 4-2-3-1 relationships; it is not a complete eleven-player formation test. Keep one defender and one pivot connected behind the attack.

Retest example: before the next reception say “check your far shoulder as the passer prepares.” Record the next five usable opportunities, then revisit in the game without repeating the cue. Describe the action that improved and the pressure it survived.

Goalkeeper and center backs escape pressure

25 x 20 area Two two-yard exit gates | Four minutes of activity and one minute to record, drink and rotate.

25 x 20 area Two two-yard exit gates



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Set up Keeper and two center backs build against two pressers. The fifth outfielder observes, then replaces a field role every 40 to 45 seconds. Two gates are on the far line; start with the keeper.

Run the station

1. The keeper chooses a center back or carries briefly to engage pressure. Center backs widen to offer useful angles; the keeper remains a support option.

2. Builders score by carrying through either gate with control. Pressers who win can attack the keeper’s goal or a marked near gate if using a no-goal setup.

3. Example shown: GK finds 4; 4 plays into 5’s moving support space; 5 carries toward the free gate. Reset after a goal or controlled exit.

Coach and correct “Invite pressure, keep a second option, then release.” If both backs stand on the same line, change their height slightly. A useful return to the keeper remains available.

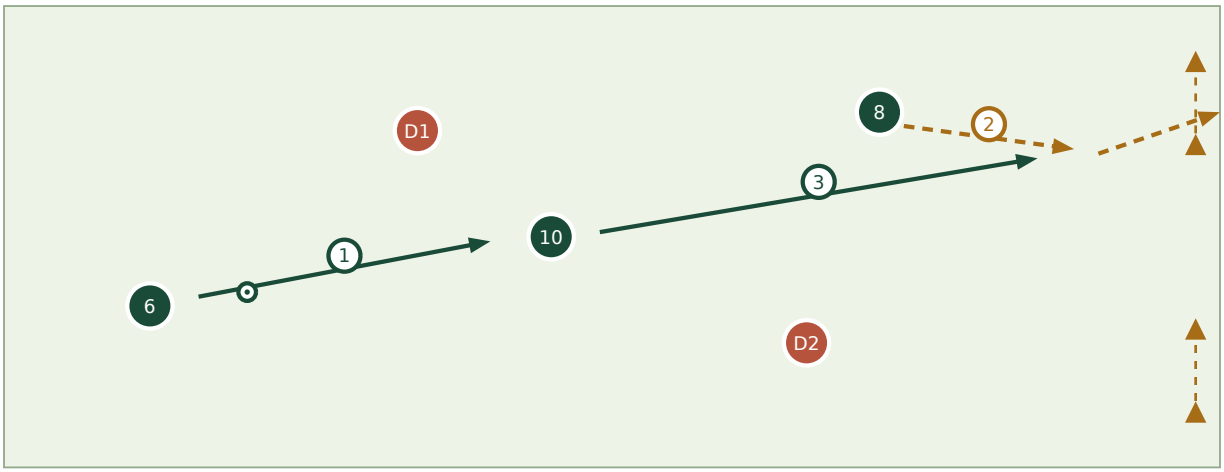
Evaluate Center-back receiving shape, keeper support and pass choice, passing angles and recognition of the open gate. Grade pressing work when field players rotate into it.

Adjust Begin with one presser for a teaching repetition, then restore two. Use identical pressure for compared candidates. Both keepers experience A during the block.

Pivots and ten connect a third player

22 x 16 area Two exit gates | Four minutes of activity and one minute to record, drink and rotate.

22 x 16 area Two exit gates



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Set up Three attackers and two defenders. Start 6 near the ball, 10 inside and 8 higher at a different angle. Mark two exit gates on the far line; defenders counter across the near line.

Run the station

1. 6 carries or feeds 10. As the pass travels, 8 adjusts into a forward support angle. 10 may turn, set or connect 8.

2. Attackers score through either gate with control. Defenders are fully live and can counter. End after a score, controlled exit or ball out.

3. Rotate 6 to 10 to 8 to D1 to D2 each restart. Give players exposure both facing forward and receiving under pressure.

Coach and correct “Check, show your next action, and move while the ball travels.” If 10 is marked, 6 may use 8 directly; reward the correct picture rather than a forced sequence.

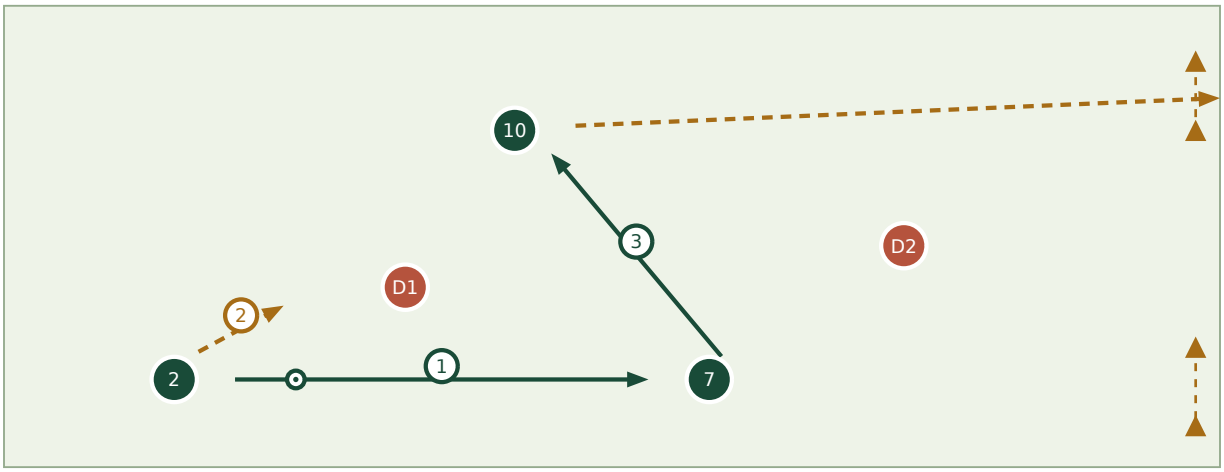
Evaluate Scanning, staggered support, turn-or-set choice, third-player movement, retained progress and defender cover. Record the role for each observation.

Adjust Use 3v1 briefly to explain. Restore 3v2 to assess. Increase pressure by improving defender starts rather than immediately imposing a one-touch rule.

Wide triangle chooses the useful route

25 x 18 area Outside gate and inside target gate | Four minutes of activity and one minute to record, drink and rotate.

25 x 18 area Outside gate and inside target gate



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Set up Fullback 2, winger 7 and attacking midfielder 10 play against two defenders. Put an outside gate near the wide corner and an inside gate near the opposite far corner. Restart from 2.

Run the station

1. 2 finds 7 or 10. Attackers choose an overlap, underlap, bounce pass, carry or reset according to the defenders.

2. Score by carrying through either gate. One attacker stays connected behind the ball as counter protection. If defenders win, they counter over the near line.

3. Rotate 2 to 7 to 10 to D1 to D2 on restarts. Change the starting side halfway through to test mirrored relationships.

Coach and correct “Exchange space and keep a player underneath.” If 2 and 7 occupy the same lane, move one inside or behind. The arrows show one combination, not an obligatory pattern.

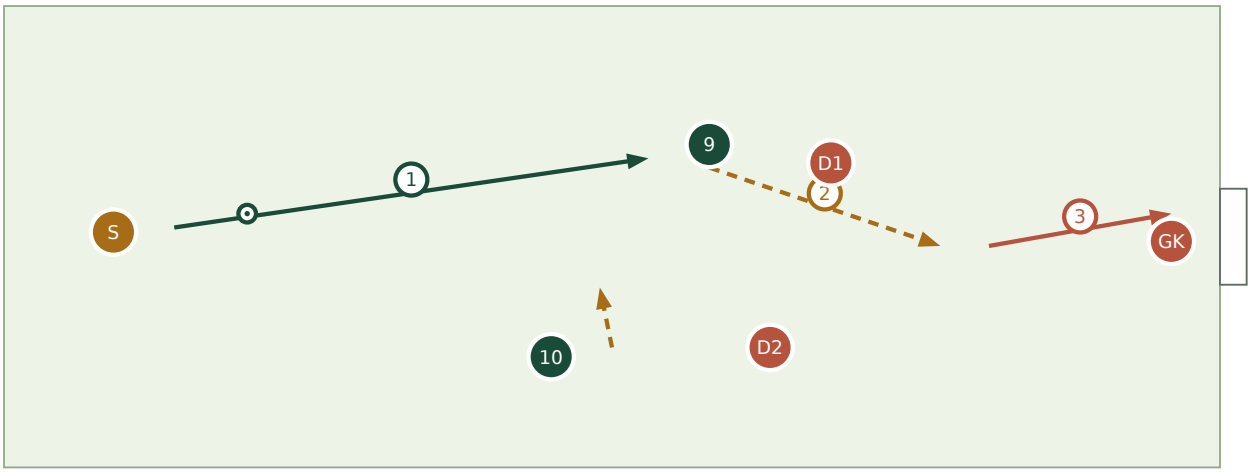
Evaluate Width and depth, support timing, release after drawing pressure, defender communication and who protects the counter. Observe both the passer and supporting runner.

Adjust Widen the area or delay one defender for learning. Restore live pressure and ask attackers to name who protects when the fullback advances.

Striker separation and box defending

25 x 20 area One goal or target gate | Four minutes of activity and one minute to record, drink and rotate.

25 x 20 area One goal or target gate



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Set up Two attackers, two defenders, one server and one keeper. Server stays behind the service line. Attackers begin at different heights; defenders start in realistic covering positions.

Run the station

1. Server feeds an attacker’s feet or a clearly available space. The pair combines to finish; the defending pair protects the center and tracks the second attacker.

2. Keep play live for a short attack. Defender regain ends with a controlled pass to the server; reset after a shot, keeper control or ball out.

3. Rotate server to 9 to 10 to D1 to D2. Keepers exchange station A and D at minute 25. Give equal service from left and right.

Coach and correct Striker: “separate before the pass and protect the next action.” Defenders: “one engages, one covers the central route.” Keeper organizes with clear early information.

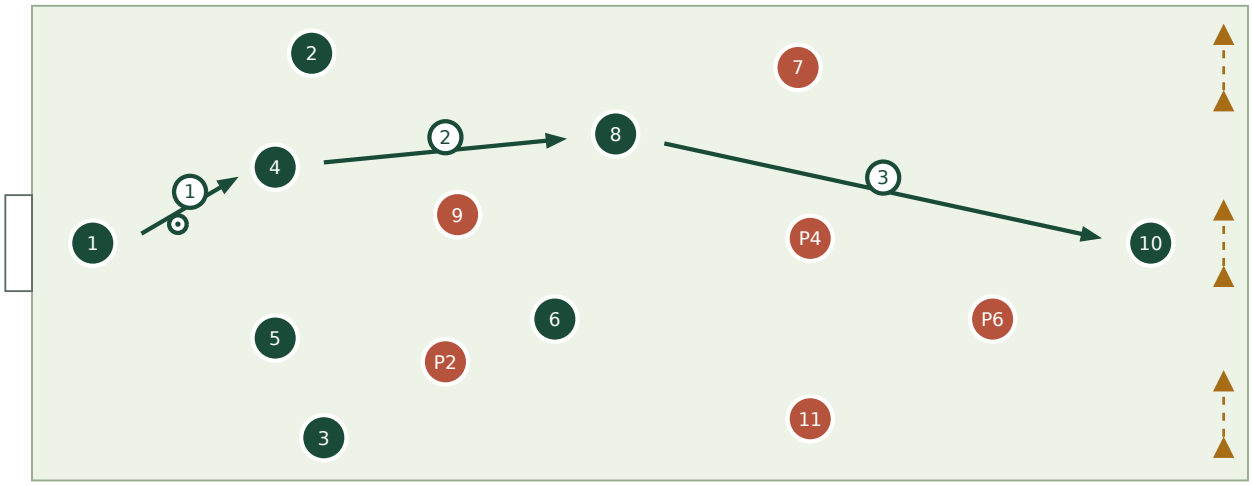
Evaluate Separation, finishing decisions, support timing, defender cover, tracking and keeper starting position. Record one positive action and one next cue.

Adjust Use a short no-contact rehearsal. Progress by releasing defenders earlier. Without a safe goal, score through a target gate and assess keeper support through station A.

Build out against a coordinated press

A 55 x 50 half-field game connects the station skills. Four 4-minute blocks and four 1-minute rotation periods fit the 20-minute slot. Use one coach behind the press and another near the building team.

Eight builders including keeper Six pressers Attack right to exit



Green = attacking team Red = defenders Gold = neutral or server Gray = rest or observer
Solid arrow = ball Dashed arrow = player movement Triangle = cone or exit gate. Positions are schematic.

1. Start at 1. Builders score by finding 10 with control beyond the first pressure or carrying through a gate. Choose through, around or beyond as the picture allows.

2. Pressers use a curved first run, an inside screen and near-side support to guide wide. On a regain they attack the main goal; keep the transition live for up to eight seconds.

3. Eight remaining candidates, including the other keeper, do a supervised low-load passing task next to the game. At each block rotate named players between active and support groups; give both keepers building exposure.

Rotation record 14 active plus 8 support = 22. Across four blocks, assign two or three active blocks per player as role needs allow; log minutes. Specifically schedule every candidate a relevant build or press role rather than rotating only after errors.

Coach “Stagger the pivots” for builders; “jump as the wide pass travels” for pressers. If pressure escapes facing forward, the pressing team recovers together.

Measure Controlled exits out of attempts; central losses leading to a shot; pressing regains with nearby cover. A longer exit is valid when the team can support the next ball.

Day 3 match evidence

Purpose: verify repeatable decisions with different teammates, in a primary and secondary role, and under a simple score-and-clock demand. Use the same evaluation anchors throughout.

Minute	Activity	What the coach records
0 to 15	Familiar progressive warmup	Keep movements controlled and avoid adding fatigue.
15 to 35	6v6 plus two keepers	Four 4-minute games and four 1-minute changes; score states below.
35 to 55	Full 11v11 when 22 are available	9 minutes play, 2 minutes feedback, 9 minutes play.
55 to 80	Changed role assignments	11 minutes play, 3 minutes role/water reset, 11 minutes play.
80 to 86	Targeted comparable retests	Clarify uncertain evidence; use page 22.
86 to 90	Recovery and selection timeline	Explain when and how private decisions will be communicated.

Four short game conditions

Block	Starting state	Coach observes
1	Level with four minutes remaining	Useful attacking risk while keeping cover
2	Green leads by one	Outlets, ball security and central protection
3	Red leads by one	Give the other team the same task
4	Level with a late restart	Organization, communication and immediate response

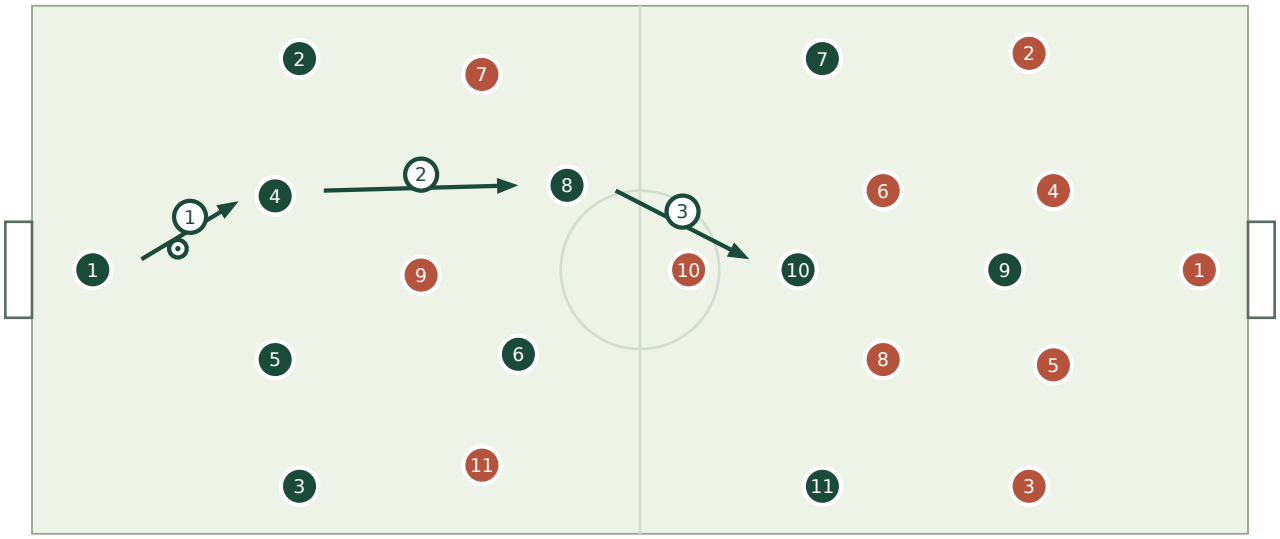
For 6v6 plus keepers, use about 55 x 40. Fourteen play; eight outfield players are in planned recovery/rotation. Keep substitutions fair across the four blocks. Do not announce individual evaluations to teammates.

Small-group adjustment: use 9v9 or 8v8 including keepers if fewer than 22 are available. State which full-team relationships are missing. Add observation later before deciding a position was unsuccessful.

See the complete 4 2 3 1 relationships

Full-field example: green in 4-2-3-1 against red in an illustrative 4-3-3. Use the opponent shape that creates useful evaluation opportunities; teach the role before judging it.

22 total players Green attacks right Role numbers are not jersey numbers



Green = attacking team Red = defenders Gold = neutral or server Gray = rest or observer
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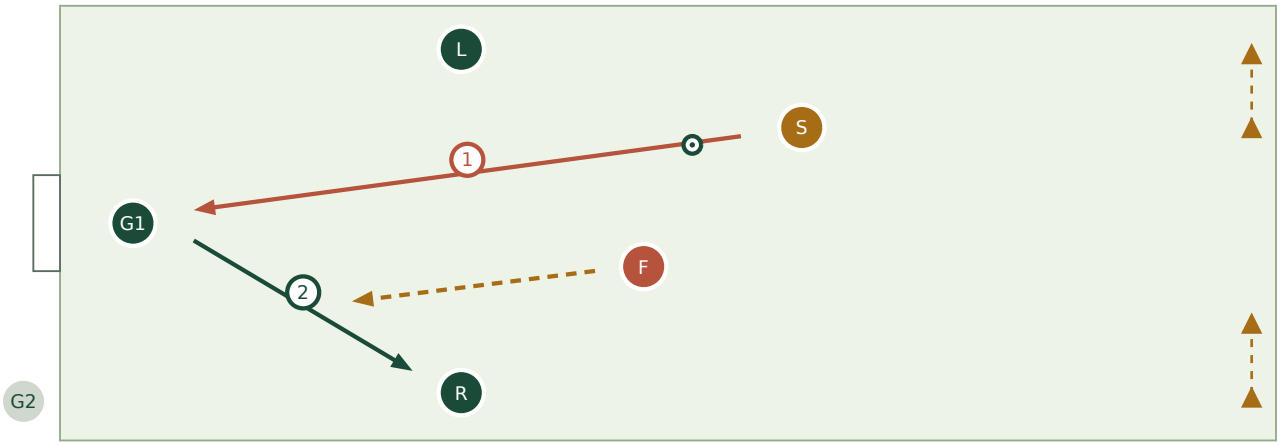
Relationship	What to look for	Useful cue
Keeper and back four	Support behind the ball; useful short and longer exits	Keep a second option
6 and 8	Different heights; one can support behind a forward pass	One connects one offers beyond
Wide player fullback and 10	Width, an inside option and cover when someone advances	Exchange space
9 and box arrivals	Threat behind, a feet option and complementary run timing	Arrive in different spaces
Team after losing the ball	Nearby pressure with cover or a connected recovery	Hunt with help or come Home

Assign minutes before kickoff: record a candidate's primary-role block and a planned secondary-role block. At 55 to 66 and 69 to 80 change a few named roles, explain the new responsibility and observe again. Team balance and prior experience matter when interpreting evidence.

Clarify goalkeeper and uncertain evidence

Select the task because of a missing observation. Keep the same service, space and opposition for players being compared. Others perform supervised easy passing or recovery outside the testing route.

Goalkeeper retest example About 30 x 25 Secure then find an outlet



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Need	Comparable retest	Record
Keeper handling and distribution	Manageable shot or pass; secure, scan and find an outlet. Add a controlled forward press only after the keeper is ready.	Service type, secure action, decision and retained next action
Receiving under pressure	Repeat Day 1 A with a matched server and then a passive closing step; follow with a live game reception.	Scan timing, touch direction and pressure context
Defender recovery or pivot decisions	Repeat the relevant Day 1 B/C or Day 2 B task with matched opposition.	Decision before and after one cue
Captain candidate behavior	Give responsibility for a short setup or organization task; observe conduct again in play.	Clear information, composure, inclusion and accountability

Use the six minutes: one minute to explain, two minutes of comparable attempts, one minute of feedback/reset and two minutes of a second matched block. If enough opportunities cannot be collected, mark N/O and schedule another observation. Give keepers their own meaningful samples across all three days; do not cram a full keeper trial into this slot.

Record evidence without guessing

Use one sheet per candidate or transfer notes to the iPad evaluation form. Include the task and pressure, so a number can be understood later.

Player name	Pinnie	Primary role	Secondary role
_____	_____	_____	_____

Station or game	Role and approximate minutes	Observed action and context	Rating 1 to 5 or N/O
Day 1 A	_____	_____	____
Day 1 B	_____	_____	____
Day 1 C	_____	_____	____
Day 1 D	_____	_____	____
Day 2 role station	_____	_____	____
Day 3 match	_____	_____	____

Anchors: 1 needs substantial support; 2 appears in simpler conditions; 3 appears under moderate pressure; 4 appears consistently in live play; 5 is consistent and helps teammates. N/O means not observed and is never zero.

Feedback and transfer

Action before the cue _____
One cue given _____
Next observed attempts _____
Later action without reminding _____

Role and leadership notes

Potential starter role and evidence _____
Backup or rotation coverage _____
Captain candidate or watchlist _____
Leadership example and next observation _____

Use the app’s twelve core-skill ratings separately from the playbook’s five weighted categories. Do not average a mixture of those two scales. If a final weighted score is used, complete every category from adequate evidence. Compare independent notes and position fit before making a decision.

Run the plan with fewer staff

Four station leaders allow the full four-area rotation. With two coaches, operate two supervised tasks at a time and give every candidate the same reduced station exposure.

Day 1 time	Coach 1 and ten outfield players	Coach 2 and ten outfield players
15 to 20	A passing in two adjacent five-player boxes	B duels in two adjacent five-player boxes
20 to 25	Other cohort visits A	Other cohort visits B
25 to 30	C overload in two adjacent five-player boxes	D finishing in one live area; the two groups alternate short turns
30 to 35	Other cohort visits C	Other cohort visits D

Both keepers use supervised foot passing near coach 2 during A/B. During C/D, both join D and alternate in goal; only one ball is live. At D, a five-player group is active while the other five observe outside the service line, then exchange after about two minutes. Every outfield candidate gets the same two-minute live D exposure. Confirm finishing evidence later in games.

Day 2: use the same cohort pattern: A/B in the first ten minutes, C/D in the second ten. Run a single keeper-dependent task live at A or D with a clearly designated waiting group; both keepers alternate. Keep other activity in the same coach’s immediate view. Log the shorter role exposure rather than implying the full station dose occurred.

Player numbers

Available	Adjustment	Evaluation consequence
18 to 21	Use four groups of 4 to 6; use smaller live games including keepers	Use observers or neutral servers; rotate those roles
22	20 outfield plus two keepers as diagrammed	Full 11v11 is possible
More than 24	Create equivalent separate tryout flights or add supervised duplicate areas	Avoid long queues and preserve comparable samples
One coach	Use two groups in one visible task; alternate play and observation	Reduce the number of distinct stations or extend evaluation to another session

When time is tight, shorten a main block or collect another day of evidence. Keep movement preparation and adequate recovery. Plan water access around weather and school procedures.

Coaching references and final checks

The station layouts, rotations, examples and 15-minute timing in this guide are coaching designs. The sources below inform general movement-preparation principles; they do not validate this tryout as an injury-prevention protocol.

[1] Johns Hopkins Medicine
Soccer Warmups to Prepare for Your Game
Open coaching resource

[2] FIFA Training Centre Tony Colbert
Athleticism for young players Dynamic Mobility
Open coaching resource

[3] FIFA Training Centre Tony Colbert
Functional lower body strength
Open coaching resource

[4] FIFA Training Centre Tony Colbert
Explosivity
Open coaching resource

If adopting the official FIFA 11+ programme, use the complete official sequence, instruction and progression with qualified staff. The short custom sequence here should not be represented as the full FIFA programme or assigned its published injury-reduction effects.

Before the whistle

1. Every station has a leader, a boundary, a waiting location and a clear ball-retrieval route. Every keeper knows where to go.

2. Player counts add up, the active and resting groups are named, and rotation time includes water and recording.

3. Coaches know the one cue, the observable action and the conditions to repeat. Unobserved skills remain N/O.

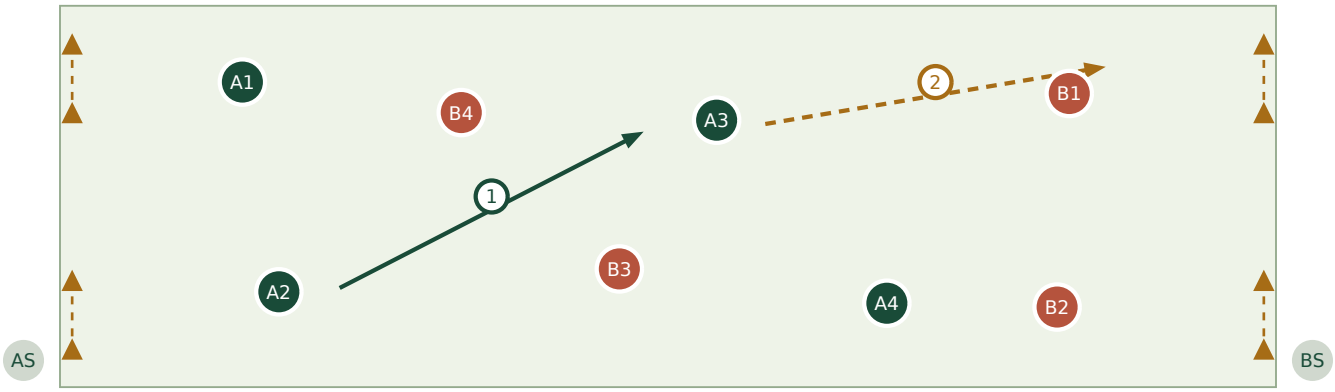
4. Feedback is private and specific. A player has a fair chance to demonstrate both a primary and secondary role.

Prepared for high school soccer. Reviewed October 25 2026. Drawings are schematic; adapt field size to available space, player readiness and the coaching task.

Day 1 game setup examples

Use these pictures with the Day 1 clock on page 3. Named substitutions preserve exposure; the drawings show one area at a time.

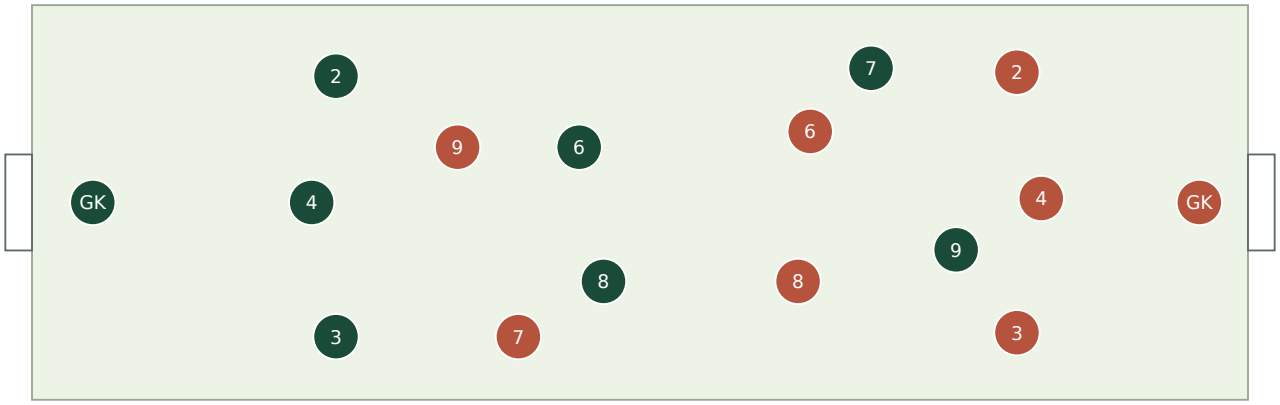
4v4 in a 28 x 22 area Two identical areas One substitute per side



Green = attacking team Red = defenders Gold = neutral or server Gray = rest or observer
Solid arrow = ball Dashed arrow = player movement Triangle = cone or exit gate. Positions are schematic.

Two areas use all 20 outfield players: 16 playing and four substitutes. Change the named substitute every two minutes. Score through the opponent’s end gates with control; rotate opponents between bouts. Keepers work with their coach before joining the next format.

7v7 outfield plus two keepers About 60 x 45 Six outfield substitutes



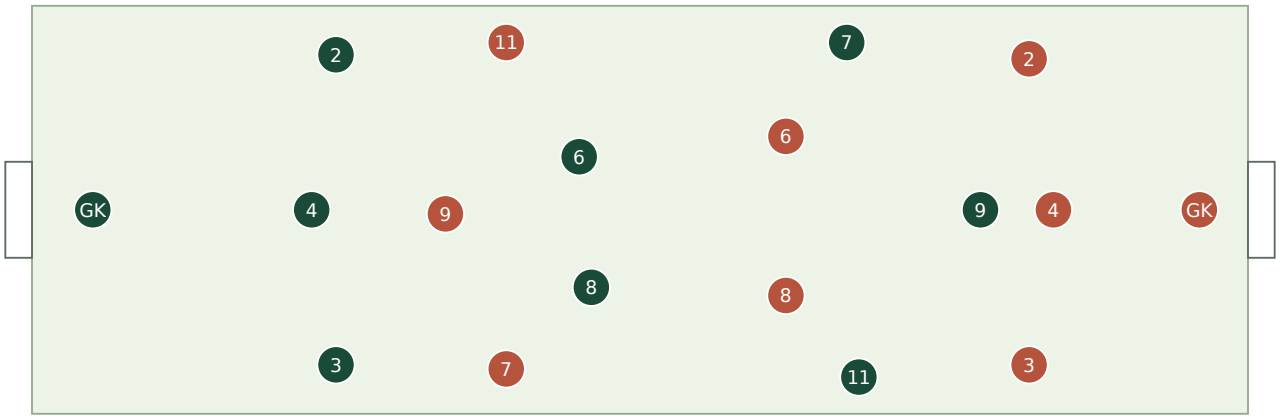
Green = attacking team Red = defenders Gold = neutral or server Gray = rest or observer
Solid arrow = ball Dashed arrow = player movement Triangle = cone or exit gate. Positions are schematic.

Use three backs, two central players and two higher players as a practical learning shape. Three 7-minute bouts with two 2-minute breaks make 25 minutes. Predetermine outfield changes every 3 to 4 minutes and record the minutes; use equal conditions when comparing candidates.

Day 2 and Day 3 reduced games

Reduced games preserve useful relationships while increasing involvement. Keep dimensions adjustable and explain the roles before evaluation.

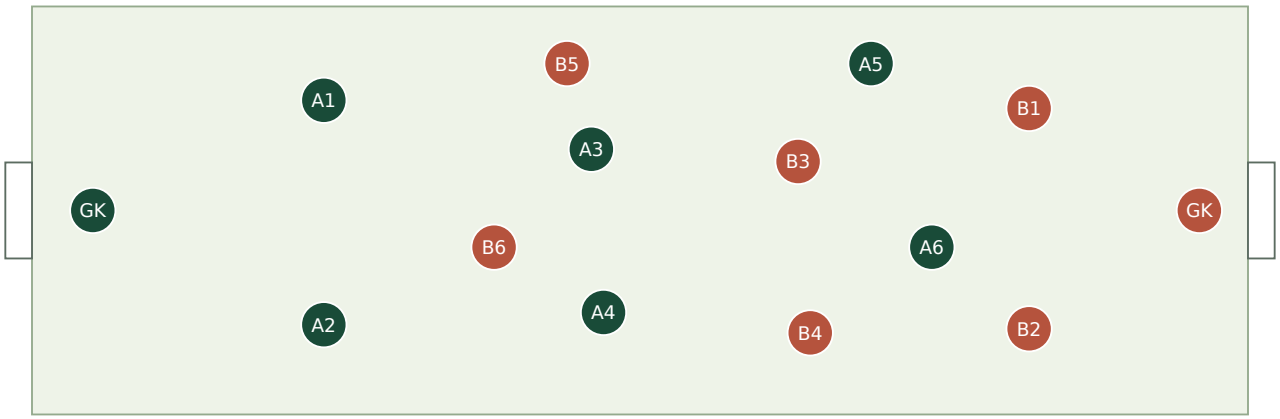
Day 2 8v8 outfield plus two keepers About 65 x 50 Four substitutes



Green = attacking team Red = defenders Gold = neutral or server Gray = rest or observer
Solid arrow = ball Dashed arrow = player movement Triangle = cone or exit gate. Positions are schematic.

Per side: keeper, back three, two central players, two wide players and a striker. Reward goals and observe width, pivot support and cover behind the attack. Use the page 14 timing and planned substitutions.

Day 3 6v6 outfield plus two keepers About 55 x 40 Eight substitutes



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Each team has two deeper players, two connectors and two higher players as a starting organization. Apply the four score states on page 20. Keep the game live, observe the response and record who had enough minutes to support an evaluation.